Soul Frontier — Complete Setup and Build Guide

Nacho Business × Adam · Soul Frontier · 2026-09-24

Soul Frontier — Your Game

Death Must Die × Dark Souls. Top-down survivors roguelite. Stamina-based combat, wave survival, god blessings, permadeath runs. Your name on it. The estate provides the research corpus, the models, and the infrastructure. You build the game.

A playable prototype already exists. Three characters: Twin Pistols (fast/light), Shotgun-Axe (mixed/medium), and a third slot. Canvas rendering, HUD, death screen, level transitions. The design doc defines the combat DNA (Dark Souls) and the game loop DNA (Death Must Die) and how they fuse.

Step 1 — Software Setup

Open PowerShell as Administrator. Run these in order.

Download from roblox.com/create — click Start Creating. Free account required.

```
winget install Ollama.Ollama ollama --version

ollama pull hf.co/OrcaRouter/OrcaSAQ-2-27B-gguf # 12GB, 70.0 SWE-bench, 262K context,
agent-optimized # Verify it works: ollama run hf.co/OrcaRouter/OrcaSAQ-2-27B-gguf "Write a Lua
function"

mkdir C:\tools -Force; cd C:\tools curl -L -o rojo.zip
"https://github.com/rojo-rbx/rojo/releases/download/v7.7.0/rojo-7.7.0-windows-x86_64.zip"
Expand-Archive rojo.zip -DestinationPath rojo $env:PATH += ";C:\tools\rojo"
[System.Environment]::SetEnvironmentVariable("PATH", $env:PATH + ";C:\tools\rojo", "User") rojo
--version

winget install Microsoft.VisualStudioCode code --install-extension sumneko.lua code
--install-extension rojo-rbx.rojo

winget install Git.Git
```

Step 2 — Connect Hermes to Your Model

Point Hermes at your local Ollama instance. In your Hermes config or chat settings:

Setting	Value
Model endpoint	http://localhost:11434
Model name	hf.co/OrcaRouter/OrcaSAQ-2-27B-gguf
Max tokens	4096
Temperature	0.2

Now Hermes runs on YOUR GPU. No API key. No billing. ~40-60 tokens/second on the 5080.

Step 3 — Free API Keys (for bigger models)

Your 5080 handles most tasks. For harder problems:

Service	What You Get	Sign Up
OpenRouter	Free access to many models	https://openrouter.ai
Groq	Fastest free inference (Llama 3.3 70B)	https://console.groq.com

NVIDIA Build	Free credits, 82 models	https://build.nvidia.com
Cerebras	Very fast free inference	https://cloud.cerebras.ai
Google AI Studio	Free Gemini access	https://aistudio.google.com

Put keys in a .env file next to your project.

Step 4 — Soul Frontier Design Document

Stamina-based. One bar governs everything. Resource management is the core loop.

Action	Stamina	Notes
Light swing	1	Fast, low damage, spammable
Heavy swing	3	Slow, high damage, telegraphed
Dodge roll	1	i-frames, roll THROUGH enemies
Sprint	1/tick	Hold to move faster

No auto-attack. No lock-on. No backstab. Enemies telegraph — slow readable wind-ups. Death is education.

Wave-based survival. Choose 3 gods per run for blessing synergy. Survive hordes, descend, defeat guardians. Runs reset on death. Persistent progression between runs through equipment and character mastery.

Step 5 — Your Prototype

A playable prototype exists in the estate. 44KB, three characters, canvas rendering, HUD, death screen.

The source code is at:

dashboard/static/games/soul_frontier/soul_frontier.html

The design brief is at:

memory/runs/soul_frontier_research_20260923.md

Feed both files to Hermes as context before asking design questions. The model needs to know what's already decided.

Step 6 — Build in Roblox

Create a new project folder. Write a Rojo project file. Sync to Studio.

```
mkdir SoulFrontier cd SoulFrontier # Create default.project.json: # { # "name": "SoulFrontier", # "tree": { # "$className": "DataModel", # "ServerScriptService": { # "GameConfig": { "$path": "src/GameConfig.luau" }, # "CombatSystem": { "$path": "src/Combat.luau" }, # "WaveSpawner": { "$path": "src/Waves.luau" }, # "StaminaSystem": { "$path": "src/Stamina.luau" } # } # } # } rojo serve default.project.json # Open Roblox Studio + Rojo plugin + Connect # Start building
```

What to build first:

Module	What It Does	Ask Your Model
Stamina.luau	One bar: attack, dodge, sprint all drain it	Write a stamina system with regen and costs
Combat.luau	Light/heavy attacks, dodge roll with i-frames	Write a melee combat system with hitboxes
Waves.luau	Spawn enemies in waves, escalate difficulty	Write a wave spawner with difficulty scaling
Telegraph.luau	Enemy wind-up animations before attacking	Write an enemy AI that telegraphs before striking

Step 7 — Free Game Assets

Type	Source	License
2D sprites	https://itch.io/game-assets/free	Various
Tilesets	https://opengameart.org	CC0 / CC-BY
3D models	https://sketchfab.com	Various (free section)
Textures	https://polyhaven.com	CC0
Sound FX	https://freesound.org	CC0
Music	https://freepd.com	Public domain
Fonts	https://fonts.google.com	Open source
GameDev OS	https://github.com/Scenario-Games/GameDev-OS	Open source
Roblox Toolbox	Built into Studio	Free

GameDev OS: 9 AI specialists, 64 skills for game assets. Sprites, 3D rigging, textures, skyboxes, walkable worlds, music, SFX, trailers, store art. Wire into Hermes via ComfyUI workflows.

Step 8 — How You Get Paid

Roblox pays 70%. $0.0035 per Robux. Minimum payout: 30,000 Robux (~$105).

Roguelites monetize through repeat runs. Every death = another run = another chance to buy. The death loop IS the monetization loop.

Item	Type	Price	What It Does
Extra Character	Game Pass	199	Unlock a 4th character
Stamina Refill	Dev Product	49	Instant refill (once per wave)
Soul Doubler	Dev Product	99	2x souls for 30 min
Frontier Pass	Game Pass	499	Access to deeper levels

Target: 430 pass sales = first payout. Post your launch clip. Your 5080 means instant, free, unlimited development iteration.

Step 9 — The Research Corpus (Your Model's Library)

Feed these to Hermes before asking design questions. The model needs to know what's already decided.

File	Feed It Because
soul_frontier_research_20260923.md	Your design doc: combat DNA, loop DNA, fusion
soul_frontier.html	Your playable prototype source
The gaming corpus (35 games)	Design patterns from the estate's games
The arXiv metadata index	3.15M papers for pathfinding, procedural gen, roguelite patterns

Design Principles

1. Death is education. Every death teaches the pattern. Difficulty is fair, never cheating.

2. Stamina is the core loop. Every action is a resource decision.

3. Telegraph and punish. Enemies wind up slowly. Mastery is pattern recognition.

4. The map precedes the territory. Pre-register boss patterns and wave compositions. Then build to the map.

5. The game is a tool for the player, not a substitute for the player.

Quick Reference

Command	What It Does
rojo serve default.project.json	Start code sync server
ollama run <model>	Chat with local model
ollama ps	See what's in VRAM
git pull	Get latest code
code .	Open VS Code here

```
1. rojo serve default.project.json 2. Open Roblox Studio + Rojo Connect 3. Edit Lua in VS Code — syncs instantly 4. Press Play to test 5. File > Publish to Roblox when ready
```

All Links

Resource	URL
Roblox Studio	<link href="https://www.roblox.com/create" color="#1565c0"><u>https://www.roblox.com/create</u></link>
Roblox Creator Docs	<link href="https://create.roblox.com/docs" color="#1565c0"><u>https://create.roblox.com/docs</u></link>
Luau Language	<link href="https://luau.org" color="#1565c0"><u>https://luau.org</u></link>
Rojo	<link href="https://rojo.space" color="#1565c0"><u>https://rojo.space</u></link>
Ollama	<link href="https://ollama.com" color="#1565c0"><u>https://ollama.com</u></link>
OrcaSAQ-2 Model	<link href="https://huggingface.co/OrcaRouter/OrcaSAQ-2-27B-gguf" color="#1565c0"><u>https://huggingface.co/OrcaRouter
GameDev OS	https://github.com/Scenario-Games/GameDev-OS
OpenRouter	https://openrouter.ai
Groq Console	https://console.groq.com
NVIDIA Build	https://build.nvidia.com
itch.io Free Assets	https://itch.io/game-assets/free
OpenGameArt	https://opengameart.org
Poly Haven	https://polyhaven.com
FreeSound	https://freesound.org
FreePD	https://freepd.com
Hermes Docs	<link href="https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs" color="#1565c0"><u>https://hermes-agent.nousresearch.com/docs

Close

Your GPU is the engine. The model is the brain. The game is the body. The map precedes the territory — build the map, and the territory follows. The research corpus is loaded. The model is pulled. The prototype exists. The design doc is written. Now build.